

Boston Sunday Globe

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Mass. native, 28, turning out lights at USAID

DOGE staffer is a man of contradictions

By Emma Platoff and Sam Brodey

GLOBE STAFF

Over the last 10 years, Jeremy Lewin has looked like a man in search of a political identity.

As he ascended through Ivy League institutions and elite law firms, Lewin, now 28, veered from one end of the political spectrum to the other, seesawing rapidly without obvious explanation. In college, law school, and his early career, Lewin took a number of stances that would seem to be irreconcilable. He joined the Dartmouth College Republicans and Harvard Law

School's chapter of the conservative Federalist Society, only to proudly label himself "team Joe" in the 2020 presidential election, and even help his mentor, the well-known liberal law professor Laurence Tribe, advise the congressional Democrats impeaching Donald Trump.

And then, just days after Trump was inaugurated this year, Lewin took on the most consequential identity yet: He joined the Department of Government Efficiency, the Elon Musk-led and Trump-blessed project to remake — and shrink — the federal government. In March, Lewin was elevated to deputy administrator of the US Agency for International Development — a neophyte appointed to effectively turn out the lights

LEWIN, Page A12

"He's trying to fix a lot of things in one swoop, and quickly. It needed attention for a long time, but it may come with short-term pain. That's where it gets difficult."



T Brian Jenkins
56, Sutton

"I'm not sure who this is supposed to help. Like, who are the tariffs really supposed to help, given the impact it will have on us consumers?"



H Vanessa Coppola
41, North Yarmouth, Maine

Republican Independent Democrat
T voted for Trump H voted for Harris

Voters weigh in on Trump agenda

By Diti Kohli, Matt Stout, Anjali Huynh, Omar Mohammed, and Sabrina Shankman

GLOBE STAFF

Brian Jenkins voted for Donald Trump for a third time in November, and he had money on his mind. He hoped the now-president would grow the economy and reaffirm the United States' position as a global superpower.

In the weeks since Inauguration Day, Trump has launched his agenda with force. White House executive orders have slashed fed-

eral research spending, eliminated much foreign aid, and brought up the prospect of restructuring Social Security and the student loan system. On Wednesday, Trump announced steep tariffs on many major trading partners, sending stock markets plunging. The ripples of these moves are only beginning to be felt, even as many remain caught in legal crossfire.

The flurry of changes has many Americans wondering: **VOTERS, Page A14**

FOR HER, A MARATHON OF ANOTHER KIND

Former sports reporter Alice Cook isn't stopped by ALS



ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Alice Cook, reflected in a mirror at her Cohasset home, is planning to run the Boston Marathon. It will be her third time running the race and her second since being diagnosed with amyotrophic lateral sclerosis in 2023.

BY KEVIN PAUL DUPONT | GLOBE STAFF

Alice Cook knows big challenges. As a US Olympic figure skater, her drive and dedication landed her in Innsbruck, Austria, skating in the pairs competition at the 1976 Games.

Nine years later, at age 30, she became Boston's first full-time female reporter in the male-dominated world of local television sports — a position that made her a familiar face on WBZ, embraced by viewers and athletes for 25 years.

Now faced with her most daunting challenge, Cook has her athlete's eye fixed on running the Boston Marathon. It will be her second time running the race — her third time overall — since being diagnosed with amyotrophic lateral sclerosis in December 2023.

"ALS Alice they will call me," she scribbled matter-of-factly on a notepad for a visitor to her home in Cohasset.

Though the disease has robbed her of her ability to speak, Cook, 69, is intent on again running the 26.2 miles from Hopkinton to Copley Square, but this time so people will know there is hope to be found in the "dark places" of dealing with ALS, also known as Lou Gehrig's disease, and because she no longer wants to "stay in a cocoon" with her story.

"I have some significant ups and downs," she

wrote. "In the beginning, I could go to dark places and cry, thinking about the severity of my diagnosis. I would worry about not being there for my kids and husband."

But family and friends, Cook noted, surrounded her with "love and optimism" that sharpened her focus in the wake of her diagnosis, buoyed her Pheidippidesian spirits.

"Let's put it this way," she said. "I never realized how comforting hugs could be."

ALICE COOK, Page C13



Wu campaign is underway

Boston's mayor formally launched her reelection bid with back-to-back speeches to enthusiastic crowds. **B1.**

Tens of thousands of people joined marches in Boston and throughout the country to protest the policies of President Trump and his adviser Elon Musk. **B1, A11.**

Meet MECO, Boston's first and only pod hotel. **N11.**

The Globe Magazine is not publishing today. The puzzles can be found on **B4.**



Gloom and bloom

Sunday: Cloudy, showers. High: 56-61. Low: 36-41.

Monday: Rainy morning. High: 40-45. Low: 33-38.

Sunrise: 6:18 Sunset: 7:16

Complete report, **A24.**

Deaths, **A18-22.**

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Lawmaker nonprofits 'ripe for corruption'

Experts point to donation 'loophole' in campaign law

By Samantha J. Gross

GLOBE STAFF

There are a few ways to get a legislator's attention on Beacon Hill.

A lobbyist or business leader can donate to a lawmaker's campaign account, which must then be reported on the state's campaign finance website. Groups can pay for lawmakers to travel to a foreign country or sit at a private table at a gala, which must also be reported.

But if a lawmaker happens to lead a nonprofit — as is the case for a handful of lawmakers on Beacon Hill — lobbyists and business interests have a third, more secretive way. Donations to nonprofits don't require disclosure and are, therefore, essentially impossible to track.

The revelation spotlights a loophole in the state's 30-year-old campaign finance law that allows lobbyists, who otherwise face \$200 campaign contribution limits, to give whatever they want to a lawmaker soliciting donations to their nonprofits — a practice that is prohibited at the federal level and raises questions by experts about what should be disclosed.

It's a well-used path. As hard as such giving can be to pin down, a Boston Globe review found that some of the state's most influential lobbying firms and businesses with interests before the Legislature are contrib-

NONPROFITS, Page A16

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